

Kaicheng Luo

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology
PhD in Economics

Cambridge, MA
Sep. 2024 – June 2030

Peking University
Bachelor of Laws, Philosophy, Politics and Economics (PPE) Major

Beijing, China
Sep. 2017 – June 2021

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Harvard University
Predoctoral research fellow

Cambridge, MA
Aug. 2021 – Aug. 2024

WORKING PAPERS

“Waste and Wasted Capacity”

Latest version: Mar. 2026

“Laboratory of autocracy: landscape of central-local dynamics in China’s policy universe”, with Shaoda Wang and David Yang

Latest version: Oct. 2025

“Emigration during Turbulent Times”, with Benjamin Olken and David Yang

Latest version: Apr. 2025

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Direction of Research”, with Daron Acemoglu, Jacob Moscona and Karthik Sastry

“Demand for Data: the Economic Consequences of Political Censorship”

Slides available upon request

“Who gets the Sun? Solar Panels and Electrification in Africa”

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIP

• Sigma Xi (Full Fellowship)	2026
• Institute of Humane Studies Grant	2025
• Castle Krob International Fellowship	2024, 2025
• Tsinghua-Chicago EPIC-China fellowship	2020-2022
• Outstanding College Graduate (~Summa Cum Laude, 1%)	2021
• Yuanpei College Scholarship for International Studies	2019
• Peking University Scholarship	2019
• Lee-Wai-Wing Scholarship	2018

CONFERENCE PRESENTATION

- China Economic Society Annual Conference (2026)
- LSE Environment Camp (2026)

- China Economic Summer Institute (2025);
- UofT-BoC Annual Conference on Chinese Economy (2025)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

- Referee: American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; Journal of Comparative Economics; Journal of Law and Economics; Research Policy

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant: Applied Econometrics	Peking University
<i>Proseminar</i>	2020

Teaching Assistant: Political Thoughts on Modern States	Peking University
<i>Freshman seminar</i>	2018

LANGUAGE

- English (native), Mandarin (native), French (A2)